



TB AUDIO PLUG-INS
Team Impulse Impact

USER MANUAL

TB Distortion

Level-Dependent Drive

Six drive curves, a level-dependent response, an independent TB character layer, and a steep focus range, from polished heat to unstable, broken textures.

6 drive curves

TB character layer

48 dB/oct focus range

4x oversampling

Parallel blend



Contents

- | | |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------|
| 01 Overview | 06 Recipes |
| 02 Quick start | 07 Tips and troubleshooting |
| 03 Interface | 08 Parameter reference |
| 04 Controls | 09 Version history |
| 05 Presets | 10 Support and license |

01 Overview

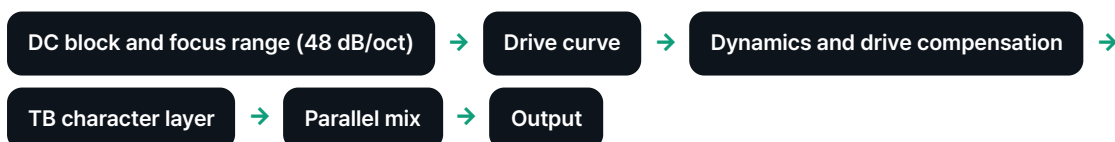
TB Distortion adds harmonics and grit with two independent layers: a main drive stage with six nonlinear curves, and a TB character layer that adds Level, Sample, Time, or Bias texture alongside it.

A steep focus range limits the distortion to the band you choose, so you can dirty up the midrange of a bass while its low end stays clean. The parallel blend and output trim let you mix the result back in at a matched level.

Key features

- Six drive curves: Soft, Hard, Fuzz, Tube, Tape, and Fold
- Dynamics: make the drive respond to level, pushing peaks harder or preserving transients
- Independent TB character layer with four types and its own amount
- Focus range with 48 dB/oct low and high limits
- DC blocking at 10 Hz and 4x oversampling
- Parallel blend and output trim
- Eight factory distortion concepts plus user presets

Signal flow



About this manual

This manual describes TB Distortion 1.3.0 for Windows (VST3). The current macOS build is version 1.0.3 and may differ from the descriptions here.

02 Quick start

- 1 Insert TB Distortion on a track. It starts with the Soft curve, **DRIVE** 6 dB, and **MIX** 100%.
- 2 Choose a curve in **TYPE** 4 and raise **DRIVE** 5 until you hear the amount of grit you want.
- 3 Move **DYNAMICS** 6: positive values drive peaks harder; negative values keep transients clean.
- 4 Set **LOW** and **HIGH** 9 to distort only the part of the spectrum that needs it.
- 5 Add texture with **TB TYPE** 7 and **TB DRIVE** 8 if you want an extra, unstable character.

- 6 Lower **MIX** 10 for parallel distortion and match the level with **OUTPUT**.

03 Interface



- 1 **PRESET** — Init, the factory distortion concepts, and your user presets.
- 2 **LOAD and SAVE** — open or save a .tbpreset file.
- 3 **Previous and next** — step through the presets.
- 4 **TYPE** — the drive curve.
- 5 **DRIVE** — how hard the signal is driven into the curve.
- 6 **DYNAMICS** — how the drive reacts to level.
- 7 **TB TYPE** — the character of the TB layer.
- 8 **TB DRIVE** — the amount of the TB layer.
- 9 **FOCUS RANGE** — **LOW** and **HIGH** limits of the processed band.
- 10 **MIX & OUTPUT** — parallel blend and final level.
- 11 **Status line** — DC blocking at 10 Hz, 4x oversampling, and 48 dB/oct (LR8) range filters.

04 Controls

Drive

Control	Range · default	What it does
TYPE	Soft, Hard, Fuzz, Tube, Tape, Fold · Soft	The drive curve. Each curve has its own character and level, even at the same DRIVE setting.
DRIVE	0 to 36 dB · 6 dB	Base drive into the selected curve. Higher values add more harmonics and compression.
DYNAMICS	-100 to +100% · 0%	Level-dependent drive. Positive values drive peaks harder; negative values preserve transients. It shapes the drive's response and is not a compressor.

Curve	Character
Soft	Gentle, rounded saturation. A good starting point for warmth.
Hard	Firm clipping with a clear, aggressive edge.
Fuzz	Dense, buzzing distortion with heavy sustain.
Tube	Warm, asymmetric harmonics that bloom as you drive harder.
Tape	Smoothed saturation with a compressed, rounded top end.
Fold	Wavefolding: the waveform folds back on itself, creating bright, metallic overtones.

TB character

The TB layer is a separate stage that works on the raw input, next to the main drive. Its amount does not depend on the drive type or the DRIVE setting, so you can change the curve without losing a TB texture you like.

Control	Range · default	What it does
TB TYPE	Level, Sample, Time, Bias · Level	Independent Level, Sample, Time, or Bias jitter on the raw-input layer.
TB DRIVE	0 to 100% · 0%	Independent TB distortion amount, unaffected by the drive type or amount. High values add more harmonics.

Focus range

Control	Range · default	What it does
LOW	20 Hz to 20 kHz · 20 Hz	Start of the processed range, with a 48 dB/oct slope.
HIGH	20 Hz to 20 kHz · 20 kHz	End of the processed range, with a 48 dB/oct slope.

LOW must stay below HIGH. Presets are rejected if LOW is not below HIGH.

Mix and output

Control	Range · default	What it does
MIX	0 to 100% · 100%	Parallel blend between the processed and the dry signal.
OUTPUT	-24 to +12 dB · 0 dB	Final level. It is a trim, not a limiter.

05 Presets

Choose a preset from the PRESET list **1** or step through them with the arrows **3**. SAVE stores the current settings as a .tbpreset file, and LOAD opens one.

Factory concepts: **Clean Heat**, **Tube Bloom**, **Diode Crack**, **Broken Cone**, **Worn Reel**, **Parallel Mid Dirt**, **Folded Motion**, and **Radio Breakdown**. Init resets to the default settings.

06 Recipes

Starting points for common jobs. Adjust them by ear and compare at matched loudness.

Warm up a vocal or bus

Subtle density and harmonics without obvious distortion.

Preset	Clean Heat
TYPE	Soft or Tube
DRIVE	3 to 9 dB
MIX	30 to 60%

- 1 Raise DRIVE until the sound thickens, then lower MIX until it is just noticeable.

Dirty bass that keeps its low end

Growl in the midrange with a clean, solid bottom.

Preset	Parallel Mid Dirt
LOW	150 to 300 Hz
HIGH	3 to 6 kHz
TYPE	Hard or Fuzz

- 1 Set LOW above the fundamental so the low end stays undistorted.
- 2 Blend with MIX and match OUTPUT.

Lo-fi radio voice

A narrow, broken, radio-like character.

Preset	Radio Breakdown
LOW	around 300 Hz
HIGH	around 3 kHz
TB DRIVE	to taste

- 1 Try each TB TYPE to change how unstable the voice sounds.

Keep drums punchy

Saturate drums without losing the attack.

TYPE	Tape or Soft
DYNAMICS	-30 to -60%
MIX	50 to 80%

- 1 Lower DYNAMICS until the transients come through clearly again.

07 Tips and troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
It only sounds better because it is louder.	Match the level with OUTPUT and compare with bypass.
The low end turned muddy.	Raise LOW so the bass fundamental bypasses the distortion.
The top end is harsh or fizzy.	Lower HIGH, try Soft or Tape, or reduce DRIVE.
Transients disappeared.	Use negative DYNAMICS or lower MIX.
Changing TYPE changed the level a lot.	Each curve has its own gain; rebalance with OUTPUT.
A saved preset does not load.	LOW must be below HIGH, and the file must be a TB Distortion .tbpreset.

08 Parameter reference

Panel label	Host parameter	Range	Default
TYPE	Drive Type	Soft, Hard, Fuzz, Tube, Tape, Fold	Soft
DRIVE	Drive	0 to 36 dB	6 dB
DYNAMICS	Dynamics	-100 to +100%	0%
TB TYPE	TB Type	Level, Sample, Time, Bias	Level
TB DRIVE	TB Drive	0 to 100%	0%
LOW	Low	20 Hz to 20 kHz	20 Hz
HIGH	High	20 Hz to 20 kHz	20 kHz
MIX	Mix	0 to 100%	100%
OUTPUT	Output	-24 to +12 dB	0 dB

09 Version history

Version	Changes
1.3.0 · 2026-07-30	The plug-in logo and name share one rack header. Previous/next navigation and save/load in the preset control were improved.

10 Support and license

Report problems or request features at github.com/TaebeumKim/TB_Audio-Plugins/issues. Include the plug-in version, your DAW, and your operating system.

TB Audio plug-ins are free for personal and commercial work under the TB Audio Plug-ins Freeware License. If you release or monetize work made with them, add a credit such as **Made with TB Audio Plug-ins by Team Impulse Impact**. Selling or bundling the plug-ins is not allowed.

If the plug-ins help your music, you can support development at ko-fi.com/teamimpulseimpact.